

- (c) M.S. Swaminathan
(d) M.S. Raghunathan

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

15. As per Economic Survey 2020-21, arrange the following states in decreasing order of milk production.

- (a) Gujarat > Madhya Pradesh > Punjab > Haryana
(b) Madhya Pradesh > Gujarat > Punjab > Haryana
(c) Gujarat > Punjab > Madhya Pradesh > Haryana
(d) Madhya Pradesh > Gujarat > Haryana > Punjab

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

India is ranked first in terms of milk production in the world. According to option the decreasing order of the states on the basis of milk production (2023-24) is as follows :
Madhya Pradesh > Gujarat > Punjab > Haryana.

16. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- | (Animal) | | (Breed) |
|-------------|---|-----------|
| (a) Cow | - | Deoni |
| (b) Goat | - | Barbari |
| (c) Buffalo | - | Bhadawari |
| (d) Sheep | - | Gir |

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (d)

The correct match is :

- | (Animal) | | (Breed) |
|----------|---|-----------|
| Cow | - | Deoni |
| Goat | - | Barbari |
| Buffalo | - | Bhadawari |
| Sheep | - | Gir |

17. Which of the following statements are correct regarding Kharai camels?

- I. It is a rare camel breed found in Ladakh.**
II. Their name is derived from the local word 'Khara' meaning saline.
III. They swim long distance in sea to reach their grazing areas.
IV. They were anciently used in the 'Silk Route' areas.

Select the correct answer from the options given below:

- (a) I and III only (b) II and III only
(c) I and IV only (d) I, II, III and IV

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

The 'Kharai' camels are a unique breed of camels that can swim. Notably, the camels swim long distances in the sea to reach its grazing areas, usually more than 3 kms, at a time even in the deep waters. Their name is derived from the local word 'Khara' meaning saline. However, there is no consensus among historians that they were anciently used in 'Silk Route' areas but some historians regard this.

Mineral Resources

(A) Rock System

*India has fairly rich and varied mineral resources. However, these are unevenly distributed. Peninsular rock contains most of the reserves of coal, metallic minerals, mica and many other non-metallic minerals. *Sedimentary rocks in the western and eastern portions of the peninsula, in Gujarat and Assam have most of the **petroleum deposits**. *Rajasthan with the rock system of the peninsula, has reserves of many **non-ferrous minerals**. *The vast alluvial plains of North India are almost devoid of economic minerals. These variations exist largely because of the differences in the geological structure, processes and time evolved in the formation of minerals. *Vindhya Range of rocks is actually sedimentary rocks formed by the sedimentation of water-suspended particles. Among these rocks, the prominent minerals are limestone, sand, china clay, etc. *Geologists define mineral as a **"homogeneous naturally occurring substance with a definable internal structure"**. *Dharwar system is considered to be the storehouse of the metallic minerals and hence has a high economic significance. This system of rocks is rich in metallic minerals such as iron, manganese, gold, copper, etc. This system is mainly found in Aravallis, Chotanagpur plateau, Meghalaya, Tamil Nadu, etc. *The largest reserves of mineral resources in India are found in the Peninsular region. It is often called as the Heart-place of Indian minerals. According to annual report 2023-24, India produces as many as 95 minerals, which includes 4 fuel, 10 metallic, 23 non-metallic, 3 atomic and 55 minor minerals (including building and other materials). The total value of mineral production (excluding atomic Minor Minerals & fuel minerals) during 2023-24 has been estimated at Rs. 192734 crore, which shows an increase of about 2.03% over that of the previous year. During 2023-24, estimated value for metallic mineral is Rs. 110785 crores or 57.5% of the total value and non-metallic minerals (excluding Minor Minerals) is Rs. 81949 crores or 42.5% of the total value.

For the year 2023-24, the estimated mineral production (excluding Atomic, Fuel and Minor Minerals) would be from 19 states of which the bulk of value of mineral production of about 97.5% was confined to 8 States only. The order was Odisha with a share of 46% followed by Chhattisgarh (14%), Rajasthan (13%), Karnataka (12%), Maharashtra (4.6%) and Jharkhand (4.7%) in the total value of mineral production. The principal mineral producing states, which have indicated an increase in the value of mineral producing during 2022-23 with respect to 2021-22 are Maharashtra (19.4%), Rajasthan (13.6%), Tamil Nadu (10.5%), Madhya Pradesh (3.13%), Meghalaya (33.6%), Assam (8.1%), Uttarakhand (1.4%) and Andhra Pradesh (0.9%).

1. **The most mineralized rock system of India is –**

- (a) Cuddapah System (b) Dharwar System
(c) Gondwana System (d) Vindhyan System

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

Dharwar system is the most important mineralized rock system in India. These rocks are economically very important as they possess valuable minerals like high-grade iron-ore, manganese, copper, lead, gold, etc.

2. **Which of the following rock systems is the major source of metallic minerals in India?**

- (a) Tertiary system (b) Vindhyan system
(c) Gondwana system (d) Dharwar system

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

3. **Which is known as the storehouse of Indian minerals?**

- (a) Chhotanagpur plateau (b) Bundelkhand Plateau
(c) Malwa plateau (d) Baghelkhand Plateau

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

The Chhotanagpur plateau is called the deposit of Indian mineral substances, due to the richness of minerals, it is also called the Ruhr region of India.

4. **A huge amount of sources found in the Vindhya rocks are of –**

- (a) Limestone (b) Basalt
(c) Lignite (d) Iron-ore

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a)

The rocks of the Vindhya range are actually sedimentary rocks which were formed by sedimentation of water suspended particles. Among these rocks, prominent minerals are limestone, sand, china clay, etc. Limestone is the base of the cement industry.

5. **Which of the following States was the highest iron-ore producing State in the year 2023-24 in India?**

- (a) Odisha (b) Karnataka
(c) Chhattisgarh (d) Jharkhand

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

According to the data of Ministry of Mines, the Production of Iron Ore in the year 2023-24 (E) was about 252.2 million tons, Odisha is the largest producer of Iron Ore. According to the Annual Report of Ministry of Mines 2024-25, the production of Iron Ore in the year 2024-25 (E) was about 277.83 million tonnes. Odisha is the largest producer of Iron Ore with a 55%, followed by Karnataka (16%) and Chhattisgarh (15%) respectively.

6. **In which of the following parts of India are the largest reserves of mineral resources found?**

- (a) West (b) South
(c) North (d) South East

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

Largest mineral resources in India are found mainly in the region from South East to North Eastern belt. Chota Nagpur plateau, Dandakaranya plateau and Odisha plateau are located in this region. Largest mineral resources are located in the peninsular region. This is known as the heart of Indian Minerals. Plenty of coal, iron, mica, copper and bauxite, etc. are found here.

7. **The maximum prosperity of minerals is in:**

- (a) Karnataka (b) Kerala
(c) Maharashtra (d) Tamil Nadu

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

For the year 2023-24, the estimated mineral production (excluding Atomic, Fuel and Minor Mineral) would be from 19 states of which the bulk of value of mineral production of about 97.5% was confined to 8 states only. The order was Odisha with share of 46% followed by Chhattisgarh (14%), Rajasthan (13%), Karnataka (12%), Maharashtra (4.6%) and Jharkhand (4.7%) in the total value of mineral production (excluding Atomic, Fuel and Minor Minerals).